

SHERLOCK'S SYMPOSIUM

Sherlock's Symposium is all about giving participants a chance to experience the world of law in action. From solving corporate dilemmas to negotiating settlements at the table and presenting arguments in a moot court, delegates will practice legal analysis, critical thinking, and advocacy. It's all about applying legal knowledge in practical scenarios while showcasing clarity, teamwork, and confidence.

Round 1

DELEGATE CAP: 2

In this round, delegates will be assigned a real-world corporate dilemma involving a specific company and will act as the company's solicitors. Their task will be to critically analyze the problem, identify the key stakeholders, and develop implementable solutions that are realistic, ethical, and legally sound. All proposed solutions must, where possible, be supported with relevant legal principles or precedents.

Delegates will submit their findings and recommendations as a written memorandum, at a deadline set by the category head. There is no live presentation or panel questioning for this round; submissions will be evaluated by the judging panel independently.

Preparation should focus on understanding the company's background, the nature and impact of the issue, and the interests of all affected parties. The solutions must be practical and time-bound, demonstrating that they could realistically be implemented in the corporate setting. **This is not an elimination round.**

Judging Criteria:

- Depth of Analysis
- Quality of Solutions
- Legal Soundness
- Clarity & Structure of Written Memorandum
- Practicality & Feasibility of Implementation

Round 2

DELEGATECAP: 2

In this round, teams are presented with a fictional dispute case file, along with a confidential brief outlining their assigned party's interests, bottom line, and constraints. Delegates will be allotted a 10-minute preparation period, followed by a 15-minute negotiation session with the opposing team, mediated by a member of the judging panel, in an attempt to reach a mutually acceptable settlement.

Teams may only advocate for the interests and constraints outlined in their confidential brief and must remain within the bounds of the information made available to them. Following the session, each team must submit a brief memorandum of understanding outlining the terms reached or, in the event no settlement is reached, a summary of their final position and rationale. **This is an elimination round.**

Judging Criteria:

- Negotiation Strategy
- Legal Soundness
- Persuasion & Advocacy
- Creative Problem-Solving
- Time Management

Round 3

DELEGATE CAP: 3

The teams advancing into this round will be shifted into a moot court setting. Delegates will be expected to heed the following mock trial procedures while acting as prosecuting or defense lawyers:

Senior Counsel: They will have 6 minutes to deliver their opening statements and present their arguments.

Examination in Chief & Cross Examination: Counsels will be allowed to question witnesses

(each team is allowed to present 2 witnesses from the case study) for two minutes each.

Co Counsel: 4-minute speeches dedicated to presenting rebuttals, closing statements, and appeal for a verdict they favor.

Judging Criteria:

- Knowledge of Law
- Application of Law to Facts
- Advocacy & Persuasion
- Response to Questions
- Structure & Time Management
- Presentation & Professionalism

NOTE:

- *The proceedings of each round may be altered at the sole discretion of the category head.*